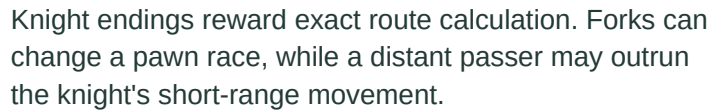


Knight-ending routes

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Map the knight's checking moves and its route to the critical blockade square. Count moves rather than judging distance by appearance.

Previous move: 60.Ng1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

60...Kg2 61. Ne2 Kf2 62. Nc3 g3

61...Kf2 The king moves from g2 to f2. Recorded reply: **62.Nc3**.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

A knight changes color with every move and may need a detour. Check the route square by square before trusting a race estimate.